

KAYVAN ZAHIRI

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AWS and GCP-certified AI Engineer and Software Developer with full-stack, GenAI, and LLM fine-tuning experience.

Experience

AI Engineer

Remote

Asurion

January 2026 - June 2026

- Built a voice turn detection system, improving auto-labeling accuracy from 50% to 88%+ (90%+ on a 400 sample validation set).
- Designed and scaled an automated labeling pipeline to auto-label 400k+ audio samples, enabling large-scale fine-tuning of a Whisper-based PyTorch model.
- Deployed the model in a real-time voice AI pipeline (LiveKit), enabling end-to-end conversational agent testing with low-latency inference.

AI Engineer

Remote

Spotly Jobs

October 2025 - January 2026

- Engineered ATS data pipelines using dlt and dbt, expanding job posting coverage by 5%+ and scaling automated processing to 500+ postings per pipeline run.
- Built 7 Dagster assets and sensors to automate ETL workflows, cutting manual engineering intervention by 50%+ and saving 10+ engineer-hours per week.
- Improved data ingestion throughput by 30–40% through optimized scraping logic and REST API handling, processing 150–200 additional postings per hour at no added infrastructure cost.

AI Engineer

Remote

Outlier AI (Scale AI)

May 2024 - September 2025

- Trained LLMs using Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback, improving instruction-following accuracy by 20%.
- Evaluated 1M+ tokens across 5+ datasets, identifying 300+ instruction-following errors that directly informed targeted finetuning.
- Refactored 3+ AI/ML models to generate more precise and succinct output.

Software Developer

San Francisco, CA

University of San Francisco

September 2024 - May 2025

- Lead developer on IDEA team software development, delivering 3 full-cycle applications.
- Created 3 business/entrepreneurship GenAI Python apps, adopted by 50+ students and professors in coursework.
- Conducted research on 10+ existing AI tools and technologies.

Software Developer

San Francisco, CA

Founders Network

August 2024 - December 2024

- Built Slack site integrations into an existing codebase of over 10,000 lines of code.
- Delivered 8 sprint cycles in an Agile environment with a 95% on-time delivery rate.
- Collaborated directly with the CEO and senior engineering team, gaining executive-level product visibility as an intern.

Software Developer

San Francisco, CA

University of San Francisco

May 2024 - August 2024

- Created and deployed 2 generative AI Thunkable apps, one of which is featured on PeopleCode.ai's front page.
- Lead developer on a full-stack PeopleMuseum project app and built a codebase of over 5,000 lines of code.
- Used React JS to create front-end UI, achieving load times under 2 seconds with optimized API connections.
- Worked on a team with 5+ graduate students and professors, delivering 100% of milestones on schedule.

Projects

Founder of ResumeAI

- AI-Powered ATS Resume Optimizer (Next.js, TypeScript, React, Supabase/Postgres, Anthropic Claude API, Stripe, Chrome Extension) — <https://withresumeai.com/>
- Founded and built (solo) a full-stack AI resume platform with ATS compatibility scoring, Claude-powered bullet rewriting, AI cover letter generation, PDF/DOCX export, and a companion Chrome extension; reached active users across 7+ countries with 80%+ week-over-week new-user growth.

ParkCast SF — End-to-End MLOps System for Parking Occupancy Prediction

- Shipped a production parking-occupancy API (FastAPI, Docker, GCP Cloud Run) serving predictions for 12.7K SF blocks at 8.98 MAE / 0.73 R² from a 33-feature LightGBM residual model.
- Built a fully automated MLOps retraining pipeline in GitHub Actions — DataSF ingestion, MLflow tracking, and a champion-challenger gate rescored on a shared test set to block silent regressions before GCS upload and Cloud Run rollout.
- Engineered leakage-safe temporal features (lag windows, recency-weighted training, KNN-inferred block aggregates) to extend metered-only data to citywide coverage and improve event-hour accuracy.

Creator of PantriIQ

- Leveraged AI to develop a full-stack mobile application.
- Built with React Native, TypeScript, TailwindCSS, Supabase, Google/Apple Authentication, OpenAI, and more.
- Scan, voice, and text input options, AI recipe suggestions, automated meal planning, automatic shopping list generation, and pantry tracking.

AI/ML Industry Data Dashboard

- Live data dashboard aggregating AI/ML research from arXiv and Medium with automated GCS scraping, trend visualizations, and Anthropic-powered topic clustering — deployed on Google Cloud Run.

Creator of the PeopleCodeOpenAI Python library

- Allows for easy access and use of OpenAI's tools and API access: <https://www.peoplecode.ai/>
- Contains text-to-speech, voice recognition, RAG, and more.
- Being used in intro courses at the University of San Francisco.

Developed a full-stack search engine

- Full-stack search engine with inverted index (Java, 1910 lines Javadoc, 1746 SLOC).
- Backend: Java 21, Apache OpenNLP, TF-IDF ranking, Log4j2, multithreading (locks + queues).
- Web crawler: sockets, HTTP, regex, reentrant locks.
- Web server: Eclipse Jetty + servlets; Frontend: HTML + Bootstrap.
- Collaboration: GitHub PRs, Eclipse IDE, JUnit testing, Maven.

Open Source

Twenty-eight PRs merged into third-party production repos, including OpenAI Whisper, merged by a Whisper paper author, Hugging Face Transformers, two into uv, merged by Astral's co-founder, librosa, merged by the library's creator, and Deepgram. Forty-six more in review, including SciPy, scikit-learn, TorchMetrics, pytest and xarray.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python (PySpark, SparkSQL, PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-Learn, Matplotlib, Plotly), Java, C, SQL, NoSQL

AI/ML: Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLM), LLM fine-tuning, Prompt Engineering, Model Evaluation, RAG, Voice AI, Regression, Classification, Unsupervised Learning, Deep Learning

Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, Git, GitHub, Bash, Docker, ETL Pipelines, Distributed Computing, AWS, GCP, MongoDB, Apache Airflow, LiveKit

Certifications

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Google Cloud Digital Leader

Education

University of San Francisco

M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

University of San Francisco

B.S. in Computer Science

San Francisco, CA

July 2025 - June 2026

San Francisco, CA

August 2021 - May 2025